

James Okafor

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## Summary

Staff-level backend engineer with 9 years of experience designing distributed systems that serve millions of daily requests. Deep expertise in Python, Go, and large-scale PostgreSQL deployments on AWS.

## Skills

Python, Go, PostgreSQL, AWS (EC2, RDS, SQS), Docker, Kubernetes, Kafka, Terraform, gRPC, CI/CD (GitHub Actions)

## Experience

Staff Backend Engineer -- Northwind Logistics (2021 - Present)

- Redesigned the order-processing service from a monolith into a set of Kubernetes-deployed microservices, cutting p99 latency by 60%
- Led migration of the primary PostgreSQL cluster to a sharded architecture supporting 4x traffic growth
- Mentored 5 mid-level engineers and ran the team's architecture review process

Senior Backend Engineer -- Fintrail Payments (2017 - 2021)

- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline processing 2M+ transactions per day
- Owned the on-call rotation for payment-processing services, reducing incident MTTR by 40%

## Education

B.S. Computer Science -- University of Washington (2015)